London-based Global Jihad Fund trumpeted Lashkar-organized training courses held in Pakistan-administered Kashmir. The advert promised an introductory course of only twenty-one days offered at the beginner level with special courses afterward.[149] Until it was taken down in 2002 the MDI website also provided contact information for anyone looking to arrange training as well as listing its contact and bank details along with reminder messages about the importance of financially supporting the jihad.[150] Finally, the group used agents to recruit youths and raise money. A brief tour through several countries illustrates the reach of Lashkar's transnational networks and the scope of its activities in the West.

The group did not have a significant presence in the US during the 1990s, but exploited the arrival of two Americans in 2000 to build up its footprint there. Both were part of a coterie of would-be jihadis that ultimately became known as the Virginia Jihad Network, which gained some notoriety because of its members' practice of preparing for jihad by playing paintball. Randall Todd Royer [a.k.a. Ismail Royer] traveled to Pakistan in April 2000 and spent several months training with the group.[151] Royer was an admirer even before arriving in Pakistan, and upon returning to Virginia he lauded Lashkar to his associates. Among them was Ibrahim Ahmed al-Hamdi, who earlier had attempted to wage jihad in Chechnya, but had been turned down due to his lack of military training. He hoped to rectify that and then to achieve martyrdom fighting in Indian-administered Kashmir. Before al-Hamdi left for Lashkar's camps in summer 2000 Royer reached out to a contact in Pakistan to ensure his confederate's acceptance once he arrived. Al-Hamdi trained with the group, but left after only a month. Approximately one year later another member of the network, Seifullah Chapman, also cut short his training. He was in Lashkar's camps on 9/11, and returned to the US soon after. By the time he arrived back home, additional members of the Virginia Jihad Network had already decided to train with Lashkar in preparation for defending Afghanistan against the expected American invasion.[152] As Chapter 6 will detail, none of them ever accessed the Afghan front, but the men from Virginia contributed to a small Lashkar network in the US. It was used primarily for logistical support, though several of those who trained with the group after 9/11 were also asked to conduct surveillance on possible targets in America.